

## W08 HYGIENE SUPPORT | O (MAX : 4 PT )

**Intent :** Ensure availability of bathrooms and support hygienic hand washing and toilet use practices for all individuals.

**Summary :** This WELL feature requires projects to provide bathrooms that accommodate users with diverse needs and to improve hygiene by offering large sinks, soap containers, hand drying support and reduced touch points.

**Issue :** All humans share the critical need to access bathrooms. Proper hand hygiene is key to reducing the incidence of gastrointestinal and respiratory diseases after bathroom use.<sup>1</sup> Access to bathrooms can be challenging for some.<sup>2-4</sup> For example, women often lack necessary bathroom accommodations due to an insufficient quantity and lack of sanitary materials.<sup>2,4</sup> Caregivers, small children, older adults or other individuals who require assistance frequently lack access to facilities that support their needs.<sup>2</sup> Despite hand washing, hands can only become as clean as the surrounding environment. Sinks may harbor pathogenic bacteria that can migrate onto hands during washing.<sup>5</sup> Water splashing from the drain may spread bacteria to surrounding areas.<sup>6-9</sup> Additionally, soap and the inside of liquid soap containers often remain contaminated after use; thus, best practice and research recommends that soap dispensers not be topped off.<sup>7,8</sup> Lastly, once an individual's hands are cleaned, they can more easily become re-infected when wet compared to when dry.<sup>5,10</sup>

**Solutions :** Bathrooms can be designed and furnished to ease hygiene, particularly for menstruating women (e.g., by supplying female hygiene products)<sup>2,4</sup> and for supporting caregivers of children<sup>11</sup> and individuals with physical and mental disabilities.<sup>2</sup> Trash receptacles, baby changing stations, large sinks, fragrance-free soap, hand dryers and fixtures that minimize unnecessary contact with the hands can be provided. Single-user facilities with gender neutral signage provide safe, comfortable bathroom availability for individuals of all gender identities.<sup>12</sup> Visual cues that promote hand hygiene may improve compliance with established guidelines in certain segments of the population.<sup>13-15</sup>

### PART 1 PROVIDE EQUIPPED BATHROOMS (MAX : 1 PT )

*For All Spaces except Dwelling Units & Guest Rooms:*

*1: Furnishings for all bathrooms*

The project meets the following requirements:

- a. All bathrooms include:
  1. Trash receptacles in stalls (in women's and single-user bathrooms). If toilet paper cannot be flushed down toilets, trash receptacles must be placed in all bathroom stalls such that they do not impede wheelchair/mobility aid access.
  2. Sanitary pads, tampons and/or other menstrual products at no cost or subsidized by at least 50% (in women's and single-user bathrooms).
  3. A hook, shelf or equivalent storage support in each toilet stall. For wheelchair accessible stalls, storage support items are placed no higher than 48 in.
- b. All occupants have access to at least one bathroom per occupiable floor that provides a stall that can accommodate a wheelchair user and care attendant.
- c. All occupants have access to at least one bathroom that provides an infant changing table.
- d. All regular occupants may confidentially request a syringe drop box, which is made available at no cost in one or more bathrooms.<sup>16</sup>
- e. All single-user bathrooms (if present) are open to all individuals with accompanying signage.
- f. If present, floor drains are equipped with a self-primed liquid-seal trap or a waterless trap seal.<sup>17</sup>

*2: Furnishings for family bathrooms*

For projects where the majority of occupants are visitors (e.g., shopping malls, airports, museums), family bathrooms are provided to meet expected demand by individuals in need of accompaniment or assistance in the bathroom (e.g., children, individuals with mental or physical disabilities) and contain the following amenities:<sup>18</sup>

- a. Changing table for infants.
- b. Children's toilet facilities or accommodations for child use of adult-size toilet.
- c. Children's sinks or accommodations for child use of adult-size sink (e.g., availability of stepstool).
- d. Motion sensor lights.
- e. Slip-resistant floors.
- f. Grab bars.
- g. At least one designated location for bags in each stall (e.g., hook, shelf separate from changing table and sink).
- h. Meets the room and stall dimensions required by local code for wheelchair accessibility.

### PART 2 PROVIDE HANDS-FREE FIXTURES IN BATHROOMS (MAX : 1 PT )

*For All Spaces except Dwelling Units & Guest Rooms:*

All bathrooms meet the following requirements:

- a. Toilets are equipped with hands-free flushing.
- b. Contactless soap dispensers and hand-drying accommodations are provided.
- c. Users can exit the bathroom hands-free.
- d. Faucets meet the following:

1. Sensor-activated.
2. Equipped with a programmable line-purge system.
3. If mixing is used, hot- and cold-water lines are mixed at the point of use.

### **PART 3 SUPPORT EFFECTIVE HANDWASHING (MAX : 1 PT )**

*For All Spaces:*

All sinks where handwashing is expected (e.g., kitchens, bathrooms, break rooms and wellness rooms), meet the following requirements:

- a. The faucet design prevents the water column from flowing directly into the drain or a sink drain stopper is installed.<sup>6,19</sup>
- b. Water does not splash outside the sink when the faucet is fully open.
- c. Newly installed sinks meet the following design parameters:
  1. The sink basin is at least 23 cm across in the smallest dimension, measured at the point where the user is expected to place hands during hand washing.
  2. The water column from the faucet spout to the basin is at least 20 cm in length (measured along flow of water, even if at an angle).
  3. The water column is at least 7.5 cm away from any edge of the sink.

### **PART 4 PROVIDE HANDWASHING SUPPLIES AND SIGNAGE (MAX : 1 PT )**

**Note :** Projects may only achieve this part if Part 1, Part 2 or Part 3 is also achieved.

*For All Spaces except Dwelling Units & Guest Rooms:*

*1: Handwashing support*

For all sinks where handwashing is expected (e.g., bathrooms, break rooms, food prep and wellness rooms), the following are present within the room:

- a. Fragrance-free liquid hand soap dispensed through one of the following:
  1. Sealed dispensers equipped with disposable soap cartridges.
  2. Dispensers with detachable and closed containers for soap refill. Soap containers must be washed and disinfected when emptied, before refilling.
- b. One of the following methods for hand drying:
  1. Paper towels.
  2. Hand dryers equipped with a HEPA filter. Filter replacement and equipment maintenance are carried out per manufacturer's instructions. This method is not available for healthcare projects.
  3. Fabric hand towel rolls with dispensers, with rolls replaced before reaching their end of service.
  4. Washable fabric hand towels accompanied by a used towel container placed nearby. Towels are washed before reuse.
- c. Signage displaying steps for proper hand washing.

*For Commercial Kitchen Spaces & Commercial Dining Spaces:*

*1: Provide Handwashing Signage in Commercial Kitchens*

The following requirement is met:

- a. Clear signage directing toward the nearest handwashing location is present at the entrance to all areas intended for food preparation and consumption.

*For Guest Rooms:*

The following are provided in each bathroom:

- a. Fragrance-free hand soap via one of the following:
  1. Individually wrapped bar soap, replaced during room turnover, and drainable soap bar racks.
  2. Sealed dispensers of liquid soap equipped with disposable soap cartridges.
  3. Liquid soap dispensers with detachable and closed containers for soap refill. Soap containers must be washed and disinfected when emptied, before refilling.
- b. One of the following methods for hand drying:
  1. Reusable cloth towels, replaced and washed at least during room changeover.
  2. Paper towels.
  3. Hand dryers equipped with a HEPA filter. Filter replacement and equipment maintenance are carried out per

manufacturer's instructions.

4. Fabric hand towel rolls with dispensers, with rolls replaced before reaching their end of service.

## REFERENCES

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